UNIT 2: TYPES OF CALENDARS

Unit Objectives

At the end of this unit, you will be able to:

- listen and comprehend a text about calendars;
- talk about different local calendars;
- work out the contextual meanings of new words;
- use the newly learned words in spoken or written sentences;
- apply comparative adjectives for different communicative purposes;
- use expressions of comparison while comparing calendar types; and
- write a well-developed paragraph.

SECTION ONE: Listening

Lesson One

Pre-Listening

Activity 2.1: In your groups, discuss the following questions.

a) What subjects do you study on Mondays, Tuesdays, Wednesdays, Thursdays and Fridays a school and at home after school?

b) What is a calendar? How many types of calendars do you know?

c) What is the relationship between calendars and human activities?

Activity 2.2: Read the following words and study their meanings with the help of your teacher.

design **accord**

Activity 2.3:

While-Listening

Information Completion

Complete the table below by writing one specific description for each calendars. Before you listen to the text, read the information in the given table. As an example, the last one is done for you.

No.	Type of calendar	Descriptions
1.	Purely Lunar Calendars	
2.	Purely Solar Calendars	
3.	Lunisolar calendars	
4.	Solilunar calendars	
5.	Lunistellar calendars	
6.	Other calendars	(a) These calendars do not have relationships with the cycles of the moon and the sun.

Lesson Two

Listening for Details

Activity 2.4: Based on the listening text, answer the following questions and compare your answers with your group.

a) What is the main idea of the listening text?

b) What is the relationship between the movement of the sun and academic calendars?

c) How do other calendars that have little relations with the cycles of the moon and the sun work?

d) How do many calendars work other than other calendars?

e) Why are solilunar calendars more successful in tracking the lunar cycle than the seasonal cycle.

Lesson Three

Post-Listening

Activity 2.5: Rewrite the listening text by using your own words. You may refer to your notes. Then, compare your version of the text with your partner's.

Activity 2.6: Get the mainstream Ethiopian calendar. Read the calendar and discuss the following questions in groups.

1. What important dates are there on the Ethiopian mainstream calendar?
2. Which of the dates are more important to you? Why?
3. What categories of dates can you make?

SECTION TWO: Speaking

Lesson Four

Talking about a special date in a family

Activity 2.7: Sit in your groups and talk about a special date in your family. In your talk, include the following points.

1. Which date is it?
2. Why is it special?
3. What do you do on this date?
4. If this date were not celebrated, what would happen to your family?

Lesson Five

Activity 2.8: Below are two pictures on the Ethiopian and the Gregorian calendar. Form groups and discuss the following questions.

1. What does Picture A show?

2. What does Picture B show?

Picture A

Picture B

Activity 2.9: Read the poem below and answer the questions that follow. Compare your answers with your partner's.

Months of the Year

Thirty days has September,
April, June and November,
All the rest have 31 days,
Except February alone,
This has 28 days clear.
But 29 in each Leap Year.

a) What type of calendar is it?

b) Which month of the year has 28 days?

c) Which months of the year have 31 days?

d) Which months have 30 days?

Lesson Six

Activity 2.10:In pairs, act out the following dialogue between a teacher and a student on the uses of calendars.

Student: Good morning, Sir.

Teacher: Good morning. How are you?

Student: I am fine. Thank you, sir. How are you?

Teacher: I am also fine. Thank you.

Student: Sir, would you please tell me how to use a calendar?

Teacher: Of course. Look at the calendar. What do you see?

Student: Names of months and days.

Teacher: Nothing else?

Student: There are dates also. Some are in black colour and some others are in red colour.

Teacher: You have almost learned. The dates and days tell you what date each day is.

Student: Colour of dates?

Teacher: The red colours are holidays, but the black ones show working days.

Student: Thank you, sir.

Teacher: Thank you, too.

SECTION THREE: Reading

Lesson Seven

Pre-reading

Activity 2.11: In groups, discuss the following questions.

1) What makes the Gregorian calendar different from other calendars?
2) How are days and months named?
3) For what purposes do we use it?

Activity 2.12: Practise pronouncing the following words and study their meanings with your teacher.

a) goddess - a female god b) evolve– develop gradually

While-reading

Read the passage and answer the questions that follow.

History of the Gregorian Calendar

The Gregorian calendar, also known as the solar calendar, is the time table that is being used in the present times. The **contemporary** calendar has been changed many times, from the original calendar that began the daily dairy. Apart from serving as the present day **international** civil cal endar, the Gregorian calendar also **regulates** the ceremonial cycle of the Roman Catholic and Protestant churches. As a matter of fact, the calendar was originally aimed for **ecclesiastical** pur poses. Though many other calendars are also in use today, they are mostly **restricted** to particular religion and cultures.

The history of the Gregorian calendar can be **traced** to the times when Rome was ruled by the empire of Roumulus. In those times, the days and months of the Roman calendar **were set a cording to the cycles of the sun and the moon**. Rather than the 12 months in a year today, the Ro man calendar was considered to be **ten months long**. The New Year commenced in Spring, on March 1, and ended in December. A new calendar was introduced by Numa, the new ruler who succeeded Romulus.

The new calendar had 12 months and ended in February. The beginning of the year was later changed from March 1 to January 1. This was marked as the beginning of the civil year. The num

ber of days in the civil year was 365. However, a new Julian calendar was introduced by Julius Caesar, the famed Roman ruler. The Julian calendar began from the 1st of January, in the year 45 B.C. Finally, a new version of Gregorian calendar was introduced by Pope Gregory XIII in the year 1582. This was the calendar that evolved into the present day Gregorian calendar that we use.
In the Gregorian calendar, Sunday was originally named after the sun. Monday was originally called the moon. The next day to Monday was named after mars, the warrior god of Rome. How ever, the name was later changed to Tiu's day for the Teutonic warrior god. Tiu's Day gradually evolved into Tuesday, as we call it today. The day after Tuesday was called Wotan's day, for the Roman god of peace. This was later changed to Woden's day, today known as Wednesday, after a Teutonic god. Thursday, originally was called the Jupiter's Day, tracing its name to the Roman god of thunder and lightning. Later, the name was changed to Thor's Day, after the ancient thunder god, which finally evolved into Thursday.

The six day of the week was named after the Roman goddess, who was symbolic of spring. Later, it became the Frigg's day, after the Scandinavian goddess of love. Finally, Frigg's day became Friday, as we know it today. There was no major change in the seventh day of the week, as it was already known in the Gregorian calendar as the Saturn's day, named after the Roman goddess of harvest. As time passed, it evolved into the present day Saturday. The months in the Gregorian calendar were borrowed from the Julian calendar. For instance, January was named after Janus, the god of beginnings.

In the calendar, February came from Februa, a big feast. March was named after the god of war, Mars. April derived its name from the name of Greek goddess, Aphrodite. The month of May was named after another goddess, known as Maia. June's name was derived from Juno, an ancient goddess. The months of July and August were named after Julius Caesar and Augustus, who suc ceed Caesar's throne. The last four months of the year were named according to the numerical placement in the year. The old names of all the months in the Gregorian calendar evolved over time, to assume their modern names.
Slightly adapted from http://lifestyle.iloveindia.com/lounge/history-of-gregorian-calen dar-6545. html

Direct Questions

Activity 2.13: Read the above passage carefully and answer the questions that follow.

(1) Where does the contemporary calendar originate from?
(2) What is the main reason for the wider use of the Gregorian calendar in the present time?
(3) Write down the two purposes of the other calendars in use today?
(4) What marks the beginning of the civil year, Paragraph 3, line 3?
(5) By whom was the last version of the Gregorian calendar developed?
(6) Write down the expressions used to refer to September, October, November and December, Paragraph 6?

Lesson Eight

Inferential questions

Activity 2.14:Answer each of the following questions individually and compare your answers in groups.

1. What do we mean by ecclesiastical purposes?
2. What was the difference between the Gregorian calendar which was proposed by Roumulus and the new form of the same calendar that was introduced by Numa, Paragraph 2?
3. How were Sunday and Friday named?
4. Why do you think that names of months such as February, March and April named are named Greek Goddess?
5. Why does the author/writer suggest that the present names of months have not been identified at once?
6. What impressions does it give when the author says that March has been named after the god of war?
7. How were the months of July and August named?

Lesson 9

Reading for main ideas

Activity 2.15: Write the main ideas to each of the six paragraphs you have read above. As an example, the main idea of the first paragraph has been written for you. Then, discuss your answers with members of your group.

1. Paragraph 1 is about the Gregorian calendar which is used by the Catholic and Protestant churches.
2. The main idea of Paragraph 2 is _____
3. The main idea of Paragraph 3 is _____
4. Paragraph 4 discusses _____
5. The main idea of Paragraph 5 is _____
6. The main idea of Paragraph 6 is _____

Lesson 10

Activity 2.16: In your small group, guess the meanings of the following words and expressions as they have been used in the reading passage. Then, compare your answers with any of the other groups.

1) What does the word "contemporary" mean?

2) What do these words refer to/mean?

- Gregorian
- New Year
- …the god of beginnings
- in those times ….
- commenced
- …present day…
- the old names….
- …over time
- …. placement

Lesson 11

Post-reading

Activity 2.17: In your groups, discuss the following questions.

(1) For what purposes do people in your community use calendars?

(2) Why do many countries of the world use the Gregorian calendar?

(3) What would happen if the calendars of the world disappeared?

SECTION FOUR: Vocabulary

Lesson 12

Activity 2.18: Refer to the reading passage and guess the meaning of the following words.

1. '…time table…' Paragraph 1, Line 1 _____
2. '…ceremonial…' Paragraph 1, Line 4 _____
3. '…empire…' Paragraph 2, Line 2 _____
4. '…ruler…' Paragraph 2, the last line _____
5. '…version…' Paragraph 3, Line 5 _____
6. '…evolved…' Paragraph 4, Line 4 _____
7. '…tracing…' Paragraph 4, the 3rd line from the last _____
8. '…present…' Paragraph 5, Line 5 _____
9. '…Februa…' Paragraph 6, Line 1 _____
10. '…placement …' Paragraph 6, Line 6 _____

Activity 2.19: From the reading passage, find a word that has a similar meaning to each of the following words. Then, make one sentence of your own using each word. Compare your answers with your group members'.

a) timetable b) original c) ceremonial

d) ecclesiastical e) symbolic

SECTION FIVE: Grammar

Lesson 13

Comparative Adjectives

• Wide/wider … than, more … than

The **comparative** adjectives are used to compare two nouns or pronouns. For one syllable adje tives and for two syllable adjectives that end in y, add –er. (Change the y to I and add er: (happy – happier). For one-syllable adjectives that end in consonant-vowel-consonant (CVC), double the consonant and add **er** (big – bigger). For adjectives that end in e, just add an r to form the comparative (fine-finer). For long adjectives (two syllables or more), use **more + adjective**. The adjectives are followed by than in the comparative form.

In Ethiopia, June has **shorter** nights than other months.

In autumn, children are **happier** than adults.

Autumn is **more attractive** than winter.

Activity 2.20: In groups, study the following sentences, identify the comparative adjectives and copy them in your exercises books.

1. The Gregorian calendar is used wider than the Ethiopian calendar.
2. The Gregorian calendar is used more than the Ethiopian calendar in Ethiopia.
3. The Gregorian calendar is older than the Ethiopian calendar.
4. The Ethiopian calendar has greater number of months than the Gregorian calendar.
5. The Ethiopian calendar is seven/eight years younger than the European calendar.

Note:

- We use than after comparatives (older than, more expensive than, etc.).
- We usually say: than me, than him, than her, than us, than them.

Activity 2.21: Construct a complete sentence using each of the comparative adjectives. The first one has been done for you as an example.

.Many people look more wonderful during holidays than the usual days.

… happier than….	… crazier than…
…more wonderful than……	… more foolish than…
… more excited than …	… more expensive than …

Lesson 10

Activity 2.22: Based on the sample sentences given below, write three sentences on the similarities between the Ethiopian and the Gregorian calendars. Then, compare your answer with your partner's.

… as + adjective + as … or not as + adj+ as

a) The names of the weeks in Ethiopian calendar are ***the same as*** the names of weeks in the Gregorian calendar.

b) The number of weeks in the Ethiopian calendar are ***the same as*** the number of weeks in the Gregorian calendar.

c)

d)

e)

Activity 2.23: In pairs, study the following sentences.

- ***…not as …as …***

a) The festivity dates of the Ethiopian Christmas and Easter are ***not the same as*** the festivity dates of the European Christmas and Easter.

b) The months in the Ethiopian main stream calendar are n***ot as many as*** the months in the Gregorian calendar.

c) The types of seasons in the Ethiopian calendar are ***not the same as*** the types of seasons in the Gregorian calendar.

SECTION SIX: Writing

Lesson 15

Basics of paragraph writing

Activity 2.24: In pairs, list down those writing activities/assignments you do during your English lessons.
Check if the following are among the list of the English writing activities you do in your English classes.

a) Writing notes
b) Writing assignments
c) Combining sentences
d)
e)
f)
g)
h)
i)

What is a Paragraph?

In groups, study the following text.

The warm weather allows me to play outside. I play on the ground with my brother. We run through the water and scream each time. At night, I play hide and seek with my friends. I usally hide behind a big bush. I love it when the weather is warm.

Notes:

- The text in the box is a simple paragraph.
- A paragraph is a group of related sentences as shown in the above paragraph.
- The first sentence has the main idea and the other sentences support this main idea.

Lesson 16

Activity 2.26: Helen is a Grade 8 student who uses a timetable to do her daily activities. The information in the box shows her schedule for next week. Use the information below and write a complete paragraph.

Monday	Tuesday	Wednesday	Thursday	Friday	Saturday	Sunday
study English	clean the house	study mathematics	go shopping	do assign-ments	wash cloths	play with her friends

You may use the sentences given below to begin your paragraph.

Helen does many things next week. She studies English on Monday. …